

Your Personal Patterns Do Not Stay Outside the Room

They come in with you, dressed as good clinical work.

THE IDEA

Your license does not uninstall your perfectionism or people-pleasing. Those patterns follow you into the session and disguise themselves as care, preparation, empathy, and flexibility, which is exactly why they're hard to catch. Having them doesn't make you a bad therapist. Not noticing them gives them more power.

WHAT THEY LOOK LIKE IN SESSION

Perfectionism	You overprepare and explain so much the client has no room to answer.
People-pleasing	You soften an important observation until nobody can tell what you meant.
Fear of conflict	You circle around what you notice rather than naming it out loud.
Need to feel useful	You work harder than the client so you don't have to feel helpless.
Hyper-responsibility	You treat every client outcome as personal evidence about your ability.

HOW TO WORK WITH ONE

Take one pattern and trace it: what triggers it, what it makes you do in session, what effect that has on the client and the work, and what behavior you'd practice instead. For example, fear of disappointing people makes you avoid time boundaries; the practice is warm directness: name the issue, give the clinical reason, invite their response.

ASK YOURSELF

Is this choice coming from clinical intention, from my own discomfort, or from a mixture of both? Often it's a mixture, and that's fine. You just want to know which.

Your patterns don't disappear in the therapist role. They become clinical behavior.